



» ASIA CUP T20 DIARY

Imagined glory: India's captain Suryakumar Yadav lifts an imaginary trophy as his teammates celebrate a surreal Asia Cup triumph in Dubai — a victory without silverware but not without symbolism. AFP

In search of a trophy, and perhaps of cricket itself

The Asia Cup final between India and Pakistan **ended in confusion and conflict**, with the champion denied its trophy and cricket diplomacy taking another hit.

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The most common grouse against cricket levelled by those who are not besotted by its nuances and vagaries is the amount of time the sport takes up. Even its shortest variant lasts between three and a half to four hours. The chaos that roiled after the

Asia Cup final between India and Pakistan in Dubai didn't help its case.

After much uncertainty and confusion, the victorious Indian team celebrated with an imaginary trophy in front of a handful of fans. Almost 90 minutes had elapsed between the last ball of the tournament and the Men in Blue's strut onto the podium. An entire football match could have been wedged in between. By the end of it all, even the journalists, who

latch onto the slightest whiff of a sensational headline, were irritable. Their frustration spilled over into the post-match press conferences, which extended well beyond midnight.

An ill-tempered Pakistani journalist questioned skipper Suryakumar Yadav's 'poor behaviour' throughout the tournament. At the same time, his Indian counterpart grilled Salman Agha about his views on the deserving champion being denied